

Donovan Chen

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EDUCATION

University of California, Irvine

B.S. in Computer Science, specializing in Intelligent Systems

Expected June 2026

GPA: 3.71

EXPERIENCE

El Pollo Loco | Software Engineer Intern

June 2026 - Present

- Collaborating closely with the Sr. Manager of Software Engineering and cross-functional teams to design, test, and deploy code supporting restaurant operations

theCoderSchool | Code Coach

January 2026 - Present

- Instructing K-12 students in 1:1 personalized lessons in **Python** and Full-Stack Web Development (**HTML/CSS/JavaScript**) from conceptual brainstorming to completed projects
- Coach students in algorithms via LeetCode, focusing on pattern recognition, data structure selection, and optimization
- Publish students' progress reports and lesson notes punctually for clients and coordinators after each lesson

Smyze | Software Engineer Intern

August 2025 - December 2025

- Architected custom **TypeScript** modules for MedusaJS V2 and **PayloadCMS** to enable management over many outlets and products, extending the **Node.js** headless architecture
- Built customer facing interfaces for Android Kiosks (**Flutter**) and WeChat Mini-Apps (**Vue.js**), integrating **Alibaba Cloud** storage to distribute localized media
- Developed QR checkout system synchronizing Flutter Kiosks and WeChat Application through custom Medusa module for cart transfer, login authentication, and **JSAPI** payment execution

PROJECTS

Reddit Sentiment Analysis | *Python, TypeScript*

January 2026 - Present

- Integrating a pipeline that aggregates outputs from a **BERTopic** model, a political orientation **BERT** model, and the **RoBERTa** sentiment model to generate comprehensive political discourse analysis
- Adapting a **RoBERTa** transformer on Google's GoEmotions dataset to detect 28 distinct emotional categories, implementing multi-label classification to capture complex, non-binary sentiment profiles
- Developing an interactive **React** web application that interfaces with the **Reddit API** to fetch live discussion threads, enabling real time sentiment analysis trends on user inputted topics

Purin Car Android Application | *Kotlin, Jetpack Compose, Firebase*

September 2025 - March 2026

- Built an Android app with **Jetpack Compose** and **MVVM architecture** to track vehicle maintenance intervals across 7 service types with mileage and time based tracking
- Integrated the **Smartcar API** with OAuth 2.0 to automate retrieval of live odometer readings, fuel levels, and lock status, with daily **WorkManager** background syncs and push notifications at maintenance thresholds
- Implemented an offline first architecture using **Room Database** as the primary read source with **Firebase Firestore** for cloud sync and **Firebase Authentication** for Google Sign-In

Fabflix Movie Website | *Java, JavaScript, HTML, CSS*

March 2025 - June 2025

- Architected a full stack movie catalog website using **Java Servlets** and **Docker**, utilizing **Kubernetes** for load balancing and **AWS** for cloud deployment of microservices
- Engineered a persistence layer using **MySQL** Source/Replica to split read/write queries and implemented **JDBC Connection Pooling** via JNDI, reducing latency for concurrent requests
- Developed a Full-Text Search feature using MySQL Boolean mode for complex query matching and secured **API** endpoints using JSON Web Tokens for stateless authentication

LEADERSHIP

Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE)

December 2024 - April 2025

BitHacks Embedded Systems Hackathon Outreach Lead

- Directed marketing/graphics committee for UCI's first-ever embedded systems hackathon, attracting **100+ hackers**
- Organized event logistics by collaborating with the tech/corporate branch for website graphics and participant information

Theta Tau, Professional Co-Ed Engineering Fraternity

April 2023 - June 2025

Secretary, Directory of Media & Chapter History

- Managed **50+ members** by coordinating schedules, recording meeting minutes, and updating national management system
- Produced rush videos, designed recruitment flyers, and conducted professional headshot sessions for over 300 students

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Technical Skills: Python, TypeScript, AWS, C++, React, MySQL, Kotlin, HTML, CSS, Dart, Vue.js, Figma, Docker, Kubernetes

Certifications: AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner